

2.3 Editors

Not a lot of us need to edit audio, but those of us that do are in desperate need of audio editing software. Let's look at open source editing software.

2.2.1 Audacity

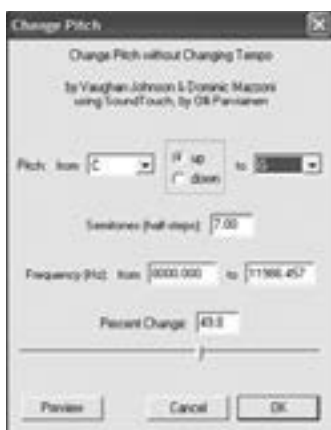
<http://audacity.sourceforge.net>

Audacity is perhaps the most popular free music editor, and the fact that it's open source means that there's a ton of support available in the form of forums and developers.

You can use Audacity to record audio from any input source, edit MP3/WAV/Ogg Vorbis files, split and splice audio clips together, change the speed or pitch of audio, mix tracks, record multi-channel (up to 16 channels—with the right hardware), normalise and edit loudness, and much more.

You can undo / redo your changes an unlimited amount of steps; it's fast, low on system resources, and has a very easy-to-use interface. Effects include pitch changing without altering tempo, or changing tempo without altering pitch, static removal, bass boost, equalisers, echo, Wahwah, Phasers, and more.

If there's an audio file you want to change, or a mix you want to create, forget about paying for software, or even the other freeware options you may find—just use Audacity. Everyone but the most professional editors should find that there's nothing they need to do (in terms of audio editing) that Audacity cannot do for you, either natively or using



Use Audacity to change pitch without changing tempo – to illustrate, it's like the speed control settings in Windows Media Player